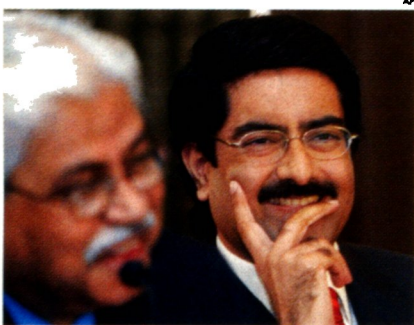


7 India Rising LN. Mittal

"It was as big an idea as Andrew Carnegie's merger of steel companies in Britain and the



US" (INDIA TODAY, March 2006). In what remains the biggest outbound deal by an Indian, the L.N. Mittal-owned Mittal Steel acquired Arcelor for \$33.7 billion in October 2006. The acquisition was perhaps one of the greatest hostile takeovers. Mittal's aggressive bid shook the world, especially Europe, with French and Indian governments intervening.



8 High on Life Vijay Mallya

Vijay Mallya, hailed as India's Richard Branson, acquired Glasgow-based Scotch whisky group Whyte & Mackay for £595 million in an all-cash deal in 2007, making him the second-largest spirits manufacturer in the world. It also restored partial peace with the Scotch Whisky Association which had argued that UB's Indian-made products were not genuine whisky, as they were distilled from molasses. With W&M, the association invited him to be a member.

9 Heavy Metal Kumar Birla

In 2007, the Aditya Birla Group's Hindalco Industries acquired US-based aluminum giant Novelis for nearly \$6 billion, making it the world's largest aluminum rolling company. "This will enable Hindalco's entry into downstream business, from cans to cars" (INDIA TODAY, February 2007).

10 The Odd Won Ratan Tata

In October this year, when the world was feeling the meltdown heat, Tata Consultancy Services acquired BPO Citigroup Global Services for \$505 million which was on the block for almost a year. A valuation nearly 50 per cent lower was what finally clinched the deal.

by Nandini Vaish

10

Scam, Scandal and Shame

A list of corruption deals that tarnished India's pride

- 1 Antulay Trust (1981)** A.R. Antulay, the then chief minister of Maharashtra, allegedly garnered Rs 30 crore from businesses dependent on state resources.
- 2 HDW Commissions (1987)** The German submarine maker was blacklisted after allegations that commissions worth Rs 420 crore had been paid in the 1987 deal in India.
- 3 St. Kitts Forgery (1989)** Documents were forged to allege that former prime minister V.P. Singh was a beneficiary of his son Ajeya Singh's account in the First Trust Corp. at St Kitts, with a deposit of \$21 million.
- 4 Airbus Scandal (1990)** Indian Airlines's signing of the Rs 2,000-crore deal with Airbus instead of Boeing caused a furore following the crash of an A-320 airliner.
- 5 Securities Scam (1992)** Harshad Mehta manipulated banks and the stock market, pushing shares like ACC from Rs 500 to Rs 10,000. The stacked-up claims of the brokers were a staggering Rs 10,000 crore.
- 6 Urea Scam (1996)** Born out of a shortage of fertiliser in 1996, a clutch of businessmen in connivance with top officials of the National Fertiliser Limited, fleeced the government of Rs 133 crore for the import of urea, which was never delivered.
- 7 Telecom Fraud (1996)** Former minister of state for communication Sukh Ram was accused of causing a loss of Rs 1.6 crore by favouring a Hyderabad-based firm in the purchase of telecom equipment.
- 8 Stock Market Scam (2001)** Pentafor bull Ketan Parekh used UTI, Calcutta Stock Exchange and his own index K-10 to swindle investors. When the scam broke out, it wiped off over Rs 1 lakh crore of investor's market capital.
- 9 Stamp Paper Forgery (2003)** Using lax regulation, unregulated trade and old machines, A.R. Telgi forged stamps to defraud exchequer of Rs 30,000 crore.
- 10 Oil-for-food Scam (2005)** Congress Minister Natwar Singh and his legislator son Jagat were indicted for procuring contracts in the United Nations oil-for-food programme in Iraq.

by Nivedita Mukherjee